

Param Thakkar

+1 (647) 568-8453 | phthakka@uwaterloo.ca | linkedin.com/in/paramt | github.com/paramt | www.param.me

EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

Pursuing a Bachelor of Computer Science (BCS)

Expected Jan 2027

SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, Java, Go, Scala, C/C++, PHP, HTML/CSS, Sass

Libraries/Frameworks: React, Next.js, Redux, Node.js, Express, Svelte, Flask, FastAPI, Django, REST APIs, Jest

Tools/DBs: AWS, Linux, Git, Bash, MongoDB, Postgres, MySQL, TravisCI, Jenkins, Docker, Firebase

EXPERIENCE

Databricks

May 2026 – Aug 2026

Software Engineering Intern

Mountain View, USA

- Summer 2026 intern on the **Vector Search** team, working on index quality and performance

Glean

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Software Engineering Intern

Palo Alto, USA

- Enabled **2x faster research iteration** on system quality for Glean Deep Research by implementing an eval framework from the [DeepResearchBench](#) paper to assess output against reference reports across **4 dimensions**
- Created a **novel LLM-as-a-Judge framework** to evaluate format quality of arbitrary reports, achieving **r=0.92 Pearson correlation** with expert reviewers and **low variance (0.02)** across runs
- Designed and ran experiments on **Deep Research** architectures (e.g. adding a Clarifying Questions module), boosting evals on multiple dimensions (**+8% Comprehensiveness**, **+12% Instruction-Following**)

Expertise.ai

Sept 2024 – Dec 2024

Software Engineering Intern

Toronto, Canada

- Built a natural language FAQ lookup using **RAG embedding search** with **Pinecone**, improving result accuracy
- Created a **Flask** endpoint to detect escalations, notifying human agents when configurable conditions are triggered
- Implemented automatic enterprise **site deployments** on custom subdomains via **AWS EC2**

Dropbase (YC W20)

Jan 2024 – Apr 2024

Software Engineering Intern

San Francisco, USA

- Refactored the Auth API and **PostgreSQL** schema to support **OAuth logins**, integrating Google/GitHub logins
- Minimized **GPT** token usage by **35%** by implementing efficient structured data interfaces for LLMs

ZipBoard

May 2023 – Aug 2023

Software Engineering Intern [🔗](#)

Vancouver, Canada

- [Implemented an @mention feature for comments](#) using **React, TypeScript, Python, MongoDB**
- Conducted research on task categorization techniques, including developing a custom classification model, fine-tuning RoBERTa/LLaMa 2, and leveraging the GPT API, to assess their effectiveness across various use cases
- Built a device emulation feature for website reviews, including support for custom device specifications

PROJECTS

[1pt.co URL Shortener](#) | *React, Node.js, Express, MySQL*

- Built and deployed an open-source URL shortening service alongside a public REST API
- Detects and prevents users from being redirected to malicious URLs using GoogleSafeBrowsingAPI
- Hosting more than **80,000** links with over **400,000** visits

[DeepGold Chess Engine](#) | *C++*

- Developed a bitboard-based chess engine, achieving **1400 elo (95th percentile)** on Chess.com)
- Optimized search and evaluate algorithms to search **1.1 million nodes / second**

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Offered the Schulich Leader scholarship (**\$100,000**) from the University of Toronto
- **Placed 1st** at Imagine hackathon for developing [Mathu](#) - a math learning platform
- Won the “Most Creative App of the Month” award from **MIT** for creating [SpellBind](#)